

Open source is pushing business app development

Software-development tool maker, Sonatype, has conducted a survey that reveals the fact that around 80 per cent of developers, architects and IT managers across all industries, company sizes and geographic regions use open source platforms for development.

The popularity of open source is also supported by Microsoft's creation of its new Open Technologies division. While 50 per cent standardise on an open source development infrastructure stack, a full two-thirds contribute to open source projects, said the report.

Also, the report revealed that 49 per cent have no effective licensing policy in place. Only 32 per cent maintain detailed records of the components used in production applications—including their dependencies. Almost everyone was in agreement about the difficulty of knowing when components and their dependencies are updated.

As most organisations are fast adopting open source software, the fact that many don't have the internal controls and processes regarding licensing in place is an issue to be worried about.

'Steam' game support for Linux unveiled

According to a video released on YouTube, the Left 4 Dead game was being run from an Ubuntu 11.10 workstation. This also indicates that Valve is making good progress with its intentions to give Linux dedicated gaming support.

Till now, the only reason users preferred Windows over Linux was that the open source OS lacked support for many games. Now, Gabe Newell and Valve's Steam might change this equation to help Linus Torvalds' Linux to face big corporations like Microsoft and Apple head on, on the gaming front.

A dedicated team of Linux developers is working to port the Steam client and the Source game engine to run primarily on Linux. Finally, the dedicated gaming support called 'Steam for Linux' could be a reality within a couple of months.



Google Drive for Linux?

The launch of Google Drive may have delighted the world but there are some who felt justifiably overlooked. Linux users are dejected at the fact that they can't enjoy the newly launched cloud-based storage service as it doesn't support the open source operating system. 'DriveforLinux' had become a hot topic and the launch of Google Drive sans Linux, made it hotter.

But, a new announcement from Google, that it would soon launch Drive



Ubuntu Linux 12.04 is here with five years of support

After months of speculation, Ubuntu Linux 12.04 LTS has finally been released. Named 'Precise Pangolin', the long term support release will be supported for a full five years on both desktops and servers. This will make it an appealing choice for many businesses. Moreover, Ubuntu 12.04 offers a new Linux desktop for LTS users, while also providing new and easy access to non-Linux applications —VMware, Citrix and Microsoft Remote Desktop technologies are now all supported.



Another highlight of the new operating system will be the Unity desktop interface. The Ubuntu 10.04 LTS has the GNOME 2 desktop as the default interface. On the occasion of the launch, Kate Stewart, Ubuntu release manager, wrote in an official announcement: "For PC users, Ubuntu 12.04 supports laptops, desktops and netbooks with a unified look-and-feel based on an updated version of the desktop shell called 'Unity', which introduces 'Head-Up Display' search capabilities. Finding and installing software using the Ubuntu Software Center is now easier, thanks to improvements in speed, search, and usability."

The free and open source operating system is available for download from the official site, while users of Ubuntu 11.10, a.k.a Oneiric Ocelot, will be upgraded automatically.